

Cyber Security Project 3

Phishing Awareness Analysis

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Objective

The objective of this project is to analyze a suspicious email, identify phishing indicators, understand the techniques used by attackers, and recommend security measures to protect users from phishing attacks.

Sample Phishing Email

Subject: Urgent: Verify Your Bank Account Immediately

From: support@secure-bank-verification.com

Message:

Dear Customer,

We detected unusual activity in your bank account. To avoid account suspension, please verify your account immediately by clicking the link below.

<https://secure-bank-verification-login.xyz>

Failure to verify your account within 24 hours will result in permanent suspension.

Thank you,

Customer Support Team

Analysis of the Email

1. Suspicious Link

<https://secure-bank-verification-login.xyz>

Why is it suspicious?

- The domain name is not the official website of the bank.
 - It uses misleading words such as **secure**, **verification**, and **login** to appear legitimate.
 - The ".xyz" domain is commonly used in phishing campaigns.
 - The link is intended to trick users into entering sensitive information.
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2. Suspicious Keywords

- Urgent
- Verify Immediately
- Account Suspension
- Failure to Verify
- Customer Support

These words create pressure and encourage users to act without verifying the message.

3. Red Flags Identified

- Generic greeting ("Dear Customer")
 - Creates urgency
 - Threatens account suspension
 - Suspicious website link
 - Requests sensitive information
 - Unverified sender email address
 - No personalized customer details
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4. Why is the Message Unsafe?

This email is a phishing attempt designed to steal confidential information such as usernames, passwords, banking credentials, and personal details. If the victim clicks the fake link and enters their information, attackers can gain unauthorized access to their account and misuse the stolen data for financial fraud or identity theft.

Security Recommendations

- Never click suspicious links.
- Verify the sender's email address.

- Visit the official website manually instead of clicking email links.
 - Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA).
 - Never share passwords or OTPs.
 - Report phishing emails to the concerned organization.
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Conclusion

This email contains several phishing indicators, including a fake website link, urgency, generic greetings, and requests for sensitive information. Users should always verify emails carefully before taking any action. Awareness and cautious behavior are essential to prevent phishing attacks and protect personal information.

Learning Outcome

Through this project, I learned how to identify phishing emails by analyzing suspicious links, keywords, fake domains, urgency tactics, and social engineering techniques. I also understood the importance of verifying emails before sharing sensitive information and following cybersecurity best practices to stay protected from phishing attacks.